



Ravindu Nawanjana

nawanjana.rn@gmail.com | [linkedin.com/in/ravindunawanjana](https://www.linkedin.com/in/ravindunawanjana) | Colombo, Sri Lanka

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Environmental and resource economics; blended finance and multilateral climate fund architecture; green finance and sustainable capital markets; retail capital mobilisation in G77 economies; energy economics and regenerative agriculture; climate policy design and institutional collaboration across MDBs and central banks.

EDUCATION

London Metropolitan University

London, United Kingdom

MSc International Banking and Finance

August 2026

Thesis: The Role of Multilateral Climate Funds in Shaping the Architecture of Climate Finance: An Analysis of Blended Finance and Institutional Collaboration among MDBs, Central Banks, and Private Capital across the G77 and China

Theoretical Contribution: Institutional Reinforcement Cycle (IRC) - a framework modelling feedback dynamics between public multilateral institutions and private capital deployment in climate finance architecture

Methods: Mixed-methods design: 103-respondent quantitative survey; eight semi-structured expert interviews with senior practitioners at UNCDF, UN Sustainable Stock Exchanges, and the World Bank GEF

London Metropolitan University

London, United Kingdom

BSc (Hons) Banking and Finance

August 2025

Thesis: The Role of Stock Exchanges in Promoting the Banking Sector in Adopting Green Finance: A Global Analysis with Insights from Emerging Markets

PUBLICATIONS

1. Nawanjana, R. (2025). *The Role of Stock Exchanges in Promoting the Banking Sector in Adopting Green Finance: A Global Analysis with Insights from Emerging Markets*. *Proceedings of the International Conference on Sustainable Built Environment (ICSBE 2025)*, Paper ID: ICSBE25_005. ISSN 3051-5874. SSRN.
2. Nawanjana, R. (2026). *The Role of Multilateral Climate Funds in Shaping the Architecture of Climate Finance: An Analysis of Blended Finance and Institutional Collaboration among MDBs, Central Banks, and Private Capital across the G77 and China*. SSRN.

MANUSCRIPTS UNDER REVIEW

1. Nawanjana, R. *The Role of Stock Exchanges in Promoting the Banking Sector in Adopting Green Finance: A Global Analysis with Insights from Emerging Markets*. Submitted to *Climate Policy* (Manuscript ID: 267297449). Under revision.
2. Nawanjana, R. *Blended finance and institutional collaboration in climate finance architecture: evidence from the G77 and* Submitted to *Venture Capital* (Manuscript ID: 262950745). Under revision.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations

July 2025 - December 2026

Country Representative, World Food Forum - Sri Lanka Chapter

Headquartered in Rome, Italy

- Chair the World Food Forum Sri Lanka chapter with 500+ members across 14+ universities in 9 provinces, operating under the FAO.
- Represent the chapter before the Ministry of Agriculture, Ministry of Environment, and the FAO country office, channelling the voices of communities affected by food insecurity into national and international policy forums.

- Advance science-based approaches to just transition in agriculture - including alternate wetting and drying (AWD), methane reduction strategies, and non-petrochemical input adoption - consistent with Sri Lanka's NDC commitments.
- Developing grassroots research partnerships between student networks and FAO-aligned institutions to scale field-level evidence on sustainable agricultural outcomes.

The Commonwealth Secretariat

July 2025 - December 2026

Country Representative, Sustainable Energy Transition Youth - Sri Lanka
London, United Kingdom

- Lead and represent Sri Lanka youth within the Commonwealth's sustainable energy agenda across 56 member states, chairing the country's director board and reporting to the Commonwealth Executive Committee.
- Oversee 3 district-level taskforces comprising government, private sector, NGO, and university stakeholders, with a total member board exceeding 300.
- Currently drafting Sri Lanka's youth-led national framework for energy transition, with proposed project initiations in green hydrogen and solar energy, and university partnerships to advance feasibility research for small modular nuclear energy.

Kangara Holdings Pvt Ltd

September 2024 - December 2026

Head of Impact Investments and Sustainability - Colombo, Sri Lanka

- Lead the design of Sri Lanka's proposed first large-scale carbon credit reforestation and agriculture programme spanning 100,000 - 200,000 hectares, with projected carbon credit revenue of \$364–\$450M per annum at maturity.
- Authored and submitted an Expression of Interest to the Climate Investment Fund (CIF) Industry Decarbonization Program (up to \$250M per country in concessional finance) in collaboration with the Climate Change Secretariat, Ministry of Environment, Sri Lanka (2025), applying the Verra VM0042 methodology across 6,000 hectares and 8,000 farmers.
- Pursued \$21M in grant funding from Multilateral Development Banks including the Climate Investment Fund (World Bank Group), preparing technical and financial documentation aligned with blended finance standards.
- Managed a cross-border impact investment portfolio (UAE, Maldives, Oman, Malaysia, Sri Lanka) with integrated ESG compliance across GRI, SASB, CDP, TCFD, and SBTi frameworks.

CIVIL SOCIETY

CuteFela - Wildlife Conservation Organisation

2023 - 2026

Founder - Colombo, Sri Lanka

Registered under Certificate No. WU18393

- Founded a Sri Lankan wildlife conservation civil society organisation focused on mobilising private sector investment in conservation with measurable financial returns.
- Initiated 3+ projects to restore protected wildlife sanctuaries and animal shelters, collaborating with the Ministry of Wildlife Conservation and the Department of Zoological Gardens.
- Delivered educational workshops and have access to conduct workshops across 19 national parks, 2 national zoos, an elephant orphanage, and a safari park in partnership with government stakeholders.

UN CONVENTION DELEGATIONS

UNCCD COP17

Ulaanbaatar, Mongolia, 2026

UNFCCC COP30

Belém, Brazil, 2025

UNCCD COP16

Riyadh, Saudi Arabia, 2024

Registered CuteFela as a Business and Industry Entity - UNCCD COP16

UNFCCC COP29

Baku, Azerbaijan, 2024

UNFCCC COP28

Dubai, UAE, 2023

POLICY AND GRANT ENGAGEMENT

Climate Investment Fund (CIF) - Industry Decarbonization Program

2025

Principal Author, Expression of Interest - submitted through Climate Change Secretariat, Ministry of Environment, Sri Lanka

CONFERENCE AND POLICY PRESENTATIONS

2026 Biomimicry for Sustainability 2026 - Paper presentation

2026 UNCCD COP17, Ulaanbaatar, Mongolia - Registered Business and Industry Entity

2025 UNFCCC COP30, Belém, Brazil - CSO delegation, UNFCCC formal proceedings

2025 International Conference on Sustainable Built Environment (ICSBE 2025) - Paper presentation
Examination Panel: Prof. Priyan Mendis (University of Melbourne, Australia); Prof. Upul Attanayake (Western Michigan University, USA)

2024 UNCCD COP16, Riyadh, Saudi Arabia - Registered Business and Industry Entity

2024 UNFCCC COP29, Baku, Azerbaijan - CSO delegation, UNFCCC formal proceedings

2023 UNFCCC COP28, Dubai, UAE - National delegation, UNFCCC formal proceedings

SKILLS

Quantitative: Survey design and analysis (103 - respondent), mixed-methods research, DCF modelling, ESG metrics (GRI, SASB, TCFD, CDP, SBTi), Excel (advanced)

Qualitative: Semi-structured expert interview design and analysis, policy analysis, institutional mapping.

Languages: English (fluent), Sinhala (fluent)